
LegislatingProgress.pdf for Hispanic Women in New Jersey

Author(s): Gloria Bonilla-Santiago

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against:

A Guidebook For A Service Model of Leadership Development

<https://digitalcommons.unomaha.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1046&context=slceguides#page=3.91&gsr=0>

organizations. Outdated tactics such as being unwilling to negotiate, and defending an issue beyond the point of practicality, consumed many hours that could have been spent more productively. Yet by defining goals, outlining a specific course of action, and exhibiting a clear and unshakable determination to succeed, task

Consciousness of self • Collaboration 47 competitive tactics-such as being unwilling to negotiate, or defending an issue beyond the point of practicality-consumed many hours of early discussion that could have been spent more productively. Yet by defining goals, outlining a specific course of action, and exhibiting a clear and unshakable determination to make their effort "work," the Latina college group ultimately jelled into an energetic,

Because of the diversity of group members, meeting sites were rotated among various cities and communities throughout the state to make possible the participation of single heads of households. Non-Hispanic women's groups and Hispanic men who were interested in supporting the work of the task force also were encouraged to participate. When the time came to get support for the passage of the legislation, the legislative committees responded favorably. In the legislative area, the group developed unique tactics, strategies, and political sophistication.

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group welcomed the opportunity to discuss their various needs and interests. Because of the diversity of group members, meeting sites were rotated among various cities and communities throughout the state to make possible the participation of single heads of households. Non-Latina student groups who were interested in supporting the work of the Latina college students were also encouraged to participate. When the time came to get support for the passage of the legislation, the legislative committees responded favorably. In the legislative area, the students developed unique tactics, strategies and political awareness. The Latinas college

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searched all aspects of the issue, and outlined the problem and a plausible solution in writing. The group also gained an understanding of what the legislation was designed to accomplish and the potential positive and negative results of enactment of the bill.

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these clearly identified various informational goals, researched all aspects of the issue, and outlined the problem and a plausible solution in writing. The group also gained an understanding of how any piece of legislation is designed to accomplish particular ends and the potential positive and negative consequences of enacting various types of bills, including the one that they

While the bill was being introduced in the legislature, the group set the stage for raising and framing the issue. Task force members created an atmosphere conducive to favorable legislative action through a massive campaign of letter writing, mailgrams, phone calls, and meetings with key legislators, media representatives, and community groups. The task force met with key leaders of women's organizations to disseminate information and educate the public. Media strategies used included live radio talk shows (with Hispanic single heads of

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meetings. Within a brief time a full-blown strategy emerged from these discussions. While the bill was being introduced in the legislature, the group set the stage for raising and framing the issue. The group members created an atmosphere conducive to favorable legislative action through a massive campaign of letter writing, mailgrams, phone calls, and meetings with key legislators, media representatives and community groups. They met with key leaders of college women's organizations to disseminate information and educate the public. Media strategies used included radio public service advertisements; college media and state

these many activities, the task force met monthly.

The success of these efforts to publicize the plight of Hispanic women was evident when major newspapers began to cover the issue in detail. Because the newspaper and television coverage exposed the issue to vast audiences, legislators became aware of broad public support for the bill.

leaders of college women's organizations to disseminate information and educate the public. Media strategies used included radio public service advertisements; college media and state newspapers. To coordinate these many activities, the group met monthly. The success of these efforts to publicize the plight of Latina women was evident when major newspapers began to cover the issue in detail. Because of these efforts, other legislators supported the bill. Throughout the legislative process the group met weekly to monitor the progress of lobbying efforts and to address other issues that arose.

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each time they helped.

Throughout the legislative process, the task force met monthly to monitor progress of lobbying efforts and to address other issues that arose. For example, task force members developed a strategy to lobby the committee before the bill came for a vote in either house of the legislature. Once the bill was assigned to committee, the group worked with the sponsor and the com-

ccess of these efforts to publicize the plight of Latina women was evident when major newspapers began to cover the issue in detail. Because of these efforts, other legislators supported the bill. Throughout the legislative process the group met weekly to monitor the progress of lobbying efforts and to address other issues that arose. In addition, the group wrote early to the governor, and then kept him informed of the development and progress of the bill, its successes, and support for it. When the bill passed both houses the

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Published: 01 September 1989

Increasing political awareness among Hispanic people in the United States has led to the introduction of legislative initiatives that have reshaped policy toward Hispanic people at the state level. Hispanic women have taken the lead in policy development at the legislative level; one such example is the focus of this case study of a legislative initiative that affects Hispanic women in New Jersey. The Hispanic Women's Task Force of New Jersey is a project of the Hispanic Women's Agenda, the Commission to Study Sex Discrimination in the Statutes, several New Jersey women's organizations, and other Hispanic groups. The women involved wanted to advocate for upward mobility and economic development for Hispanic

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G. Legislating progress for His- panic women in New Jersey. Social Work, 34(3): 270-72, May 1989. School of Social Work, Rutgers-The Suite Univ., 327 Cooper St., Camden, NJ 08102
Increasing politica] awareness among Hispanic people in the U.S. hes led to thé introduction of legislative initiatives that have reshaped policy toward Hispanics at the state level. Hispanic women have taken the lead in legislative policy development at the state level; aa example is offered in thé case study of a legislative initiative that affects Hispanic wonen in New Jersey. The Hispanic Women's Task Force of New Jersey is a project of the Hispanic Women's Agenda, the Commission to Study Sex Discrimination m thé Stamtel, several New Jersey women's organizations, and ether Hispanic groups. The

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Wing, A. K. (1990). Brief reflections toward a multiplicative theory and praxis of being. *Berkeley Women's LJ*, 6, 181. <https://lawcat.berkeley.edu/nanna/record/1113675/files/fulltext.pdf?with>

The bill as proposed to the legislature by the Hispanic Women's Task Force called for establishment of three model centers to provide services to Hispanic women. The b state legislature in 1986. Among the services to be provided are: job training and placement; basic English-language skills training; bicultural resources; asser- tiveness, survival, and coping skills training; educational evaluations; career information; financial, credit, tax,

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ong insurance, and business assistance; in- has formation and referral services concern- ini- ing legal assistance for domestic ard violence, sexual assault, family support, rel. and sex discrimination; health care in- l in formation concerning family planning, ive substance abuse, nutrition, and mental his health; and public assistance and child hat care information.

The New Jersey Senate Appropria- tions Subcommittee amended the bill and reduced the total general fund appropria- tion from \$750,000 to \$400,000. The re- duction was made for political reasons.

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in New Jersey. The Hispanic Women's Task Force 9 5 proposed, designed and pushed through the Hispanic Women's Demonstration Resource Centers Act. 9 6 Among the services provided in the model centers are: job training, placement, English language skills, bicultural resources, assertiveness, survival and coping skills, educational evaluations, career info, financial, credit, tax, insurance and business assistance; information and referral services covering legal assistance for domestic violence, sexual assault, family support and sex discrimination; health care information concerning family planning, substance abuse, nutrition and mental health; and public assistance and child care information. 97 Although incredibly underfunded (\$400,000), "this

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<https://www.nytimes.com/1974/11/04/archives/hispanic-affairs-office-to-be-created-by-byrne.html>

Governor Brendan Byrne announced the establishment of this agency during the fifth annual convention of the Puerto Rican Congress of New Jersey, on November 4, 1974. At that time, the Governor asked the Puerto Rican Congress to recommend personnel for the Office and members to serve on an Advisory Committee. The new Office was to function as a unit of the State's Division of Public Affairs, and its purpose was to "provide better communication and liaison between the Hispanic community and the Governor's Office." of the Office was to offer technical assistance in the organization, research and information dissemination to various groups throughout the State.

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Seminars on Latino awareness: These recommendations were the first attempt to operationalize the spirit of the legislation which established the Office and to implement a meaningful plan to increase the service delivery capacity within the Latino community itself.

Although by most accounts the OHA was off to a good start within the community and he administration, it also received its share of criticism. The Puerto Rican Congress of New Jersey was a vocal critic during the earliest stages of the Office. While the criticism of the Office was in part a broader attack by the Congress on what was described as the ineffectiveness of the State's affirmative action plan to hire more Spanish speaking employees in State government, the OHA was moved to develop a higher profile internally, in its dealings with other State entities, and externally in its dealings with the public, in order to respond positively to its critics.

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improve these archived versions. NEW BRUNSWICK, Nov. 3 Governor Byrne will establish State Office for Hispanic Affairs within "the next couple of weeks." The Governor, appearing yesterday before the fifth annual convention of the Puerto Rican Congress of New Jersey, told the organization that it would be asked to recommend personnel for the office and for an advisory committee. Governor Byrne, who opened the convention, asserted that the prime function of the new office

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ion, asserted that the prime function of the new office would be to "provide better communication and liaison between the Hispanic community and the Governor's office." It will function, he said, as a unit of the state's Division of Public Affairs. Although the Governor's statement was enthusiastically received, the resolutions of the convention, drafted in caucus by 375 delegates from 22 communities and members of the board of Congress ca

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January 1, 1975 for the purpose of assisting the Latino population in the State of New Jersey in gaining access to and participating in the public policy process.

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uffocation of our communities was not. Byrne opened the organization's fifth annual convention last year with the announcement that he was establishing the office to "provide better communication and liaison between the Hispanic community and the Governor's office." Attack However, Alfonso A. Roman, the president of the congress, said: "When the Governor announced the establishment of the Hispanic office, we thought it was an

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: "When the Governor asked our advice on establishing the Hispanic office, we told him we wanted it at a level not as part of an existing department but as a separate office. The Hispanic office was part of a broad attack on what was described as the ineffectiveness of the state's affirmative-action plan to hire more Spanish speaking employees in government of the state. On this point, Mr. Roman said: "When we see that the state do not have even a single Latino in its top positions,

Hispanic Affairs.

Dougherty, F. C. (1974, November 4). Hispanic Affairs Office To Be Created by Byrne. The New York Times, p.41.

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LatinaBatteredWomen

Latina Battered Women Barriers to Service Delivery and Cultural Considerations

G Bonilla-Santiago - Helping battered women ..., 1996 - Oxford University Press New York

Note RU lib has it as 2002

[Latina Battered Women Barriers to Service Delivery and Cultural Considerations](#)

Santiago, Gloria Bonilla; Roberts, Albert R.

Handbook of Domestic Violence Intervention Strategies, 2002

Got chapter from ru lib, but also <https://ndl.ethernet.edu.et/bitstream/123456789/31169/1/107.Nicolas%20Balacheff.pdf> also 2002

<https://doczz.net/doc/8741655/domestic-violence-against-latinas-by-latino-males> 1994

Boston College Third World Law Journal

Vol 14 iss 2 art 2

Domestic Violence Against Latinas by LatinoMales: An Analysis of Race, National Origin, and Gender Differentials Jenny Rivera

whose cultural norms differ from those prevailing in the United States. The impact of these differences on Latinas' lives has led researchers to conclude that these women need support services that are targeted to their specific issues to a greater extent than do other battered women (Gondolf et al., 1988; O'Keefe, 1994; West et al., 1998). their care and intervention and their legislative policy. Law enforcement officials' education must be coordinated with community-based organizations and Latino advocates. Otherwise, the education programs will reflect ingrained stereotypes and merely intensify the problems that the education efforts seek to remedy.

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The lack of education of this group of respondents is noticeable compared with that of other females. Because of the high rate of pregnancy among adolescent Latinas, these women are also less likely than other females to finish high school or to complete an education or job-training program.

Although domestic violence cuts across ethnic, religious, and economic lines, these undocumented Latina women face serious difficulties because of

addition, Latinas commonly found in the United States may experience cultural isolation. The impact of these differences on Latinas' lives has led one researcher to conclude that Latinas need support services-targeted to their specific needs-to a greater extent than other battered women. 20 Understanding the dynamic interplay of race and ethnicity in Latinas' lives first requires an Officials must develop such education strategies with input from community-based organizations and Latino advocates. Otherwise, education programs will reflect ingrained stereotypes and replicate the same problems that the programs are designed to address. To be successful, community education projects must be founded and located within the target communities. Advocates and boys is higher than for Latinas, 34 at 42%. 1994J VIOLENCE AGAINST LATINAS 239 pregnancy among adolescent Latinas, they are also less likely than other females to complete their high school education or to subsequently pursue completion of an education or job training program. 44 In addition, recent studies suggest that Latinas' experiences in school could negatively impact their

to finish high school or [redacted] education or job-training program.

Although domestic violence cuts across ethnic, religious, and economic lines, these undocumented Latina women face serious difficulties because of [redacted] cause of their society's more frequent use of weapons such as knives and guns, which was seen as a threat to their life. The following quotations reflect the feelings of anger, fear, and isolation of two Latinas:

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The first time I went to the hospital [he] had broken my nose and cut my head open. He hit me on the head with metal, and I got 17 stitches over my ear. I can't hear well on that side since that happened. The other time, I was pregnant with my third child. . . . [he] hit me and kicked me with a weapon so that I almost miscarried in my 6th month. You know, [my son] has always been a slow learner, and I think it's because of the beating before he was born. (Interview with shelter participant, August 20, 1992)

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Latina Battered Women 469

One time the neighbors called the police. They heard screaming and yelling. He had been hitting me and throwing knives and threatening me around the house. A police officer came to the door and asked if everything was all right. You know, he stood right behind me, and I had to say that everything was fine. I was afraid he'd do something if I did. (Interview with shelter participant, August 10, 1992)

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The economic existence of battered Latinas is often based on "underground" employment sources and markets. Many of these battered women are not native speakers of English and have limited English-language comprehension. Thus they are unemployable due to their lack of skills and competencies at higher rates than white or black women. The choices available to Latina women in response to being abused and leaving home were few in comparison to those available to white women. White women felt that they could go to a shelter or police and feel temporarily protected. Latinas have a sense of futility in seeking police assistance:

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isolation, deprivation and humiliation. These guidelines further recognize that the violence "cuts across all racial, ethnic, religious, educational and socio-economic lines." Although the general issue of domestic violence has

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me how long I took and if it's longer than what he expected, he accuses me of being with another man. Can you imagine? I barely have time to hurry there and back, I'm not seeing anyone, really. 19 20 The first time I went to the hospital [he] had broken my nose and cut my head open. He hit me on the head with a wooden clothes hanger and I got seventeen stitches over my ear. I can't hear well on that side since that happened. The other time I was pregnant with my third boy. [He] hit me and kicked me to hurry there and back, I'm not seeing anyone, really. 19 20 The first time I went to the hospital [he] had broken my nose and cut my head open. He hit me on the head with a wooden clothes hanger and I got seventeen stitches over my ear. I can't hear well on that side since that happened. The other time I was pregnant with my third boy. [He] hit me and kicked me

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[latinas-by-latino-males](#)

nos. 32 Three final factors often limit Latinos' economic and political strength. First, because a large number of Latinos are neither citizens nor legal permanent residents, their economic existence is often based on "underground" employment sources and markets. They remain unable to fully utilize critical services such as social and medical assistance programs. Second, many Latinos are not native English speakers and have limited English language comprehension

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The economic existence of battered Latinas is often based on "under-
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 prehension. Thus they are unemployable due to their lack of skills and com-
 petencies at higher rates than white or black women. The choices available
 the disempowerment of a male member of the community. The internal con-
 flict and external pressure to cast police officials as outsiders, hostile to the
 community, frustrate the Exclude this Text empowerment. There is evidence
 that officers have reacted to such arrest policies by arresting both the man
 and the woman, in a so-called dual arrest. This occurred with Latinas in our
 study. Empowerment is unlikely when women are treated as if they have

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 comprehension. Although fluent in Spanish, their lack of
 English language skills places them at a competitive
 disadvantage. Second, when the officer does not speak
 Spanish and the woman speaks little or no English, the
 empowerment potential again is diminished. Third,
 evidence suggests that police officers react to such arrest
 policies by arresting both the man and the woman-so
 called "dual" arrests."88 Empowerment is unlikely when
 women are treated as if they have acted illegally. are as

it's under Gloria's recommendations section!:

RECOMMENDATIONS

New methods and strategies to respond to cultural and racial differences
 must be central in dealing with the domestic violence movement. The issues,
 problems, and experiences of battered Latinas have not been taken into con-
 sideration in the human services and social work community or by direct
 courts and other governmental institutions.

Extensive cultural diversity education efforts must be linked to mandatory
 arrest policies to inform the community of the policies and duties of the
 police. As documented by Wiist and McFarlane (1998), social service work-
 ers need to inform abused women that retaliatory abuse is a common re-
 sponse when reporting abuse to the police. Fears of deportation must be
 addressed through extensive education efforts and by the good-faith conduct
 of the appropriate agencies. Exclude this Text

A great deal of work with domestic violence has centered on establishing
 and maintaining shelters and increased traditional social services. These are
 recognized as critical provisions for battered women. However, Latinas have
 not received sufficient resources and services to address their multiple needs
 within these shelters. Alternative, culturally appropriate services need to be
 available for those Latinas who may seek assistance, but all would not con-
 sideration. Community-based organizations must be retained to provide
 Exclude this Text latina battered women. These organizations also need to be
 provided with the financial and political flexibility to develop and implement
 domestic violence shelters and services. The Latino community leadership
 must prioritize domestic violence initiatives with the legislature and govern-
 ment officials in order to address this serious and growing problem.

a "private" issue will help ensure that the concerns of
 Latinas are factored into the equation of feminist reform of
 domestic violence discourse. 128 V. CONCLUSION
 Consideration of and responsiveness to cultural and racial
 differences must be central to any strategy in the
 domestic violence movement. In the past, reforms have
 been drafted and implemented without consideration of
 policies do not fully serve the needs of the Latino
 community, and may place Latinas in increased danger.
 Extensive educational efforts therefore must be linked to
 mandatory arrest policies to inform the community of
 the policy and of the duties imposed on the police. Good
 faith and trust must be established by having the police
 work with Latino organizations and Latina advocates whose
 reputations and commitment to the community are well
 established. Much of the movement against domestic
 violence has centered on the establishment and
 maintenance of shelters and increased social services.
 These are recognized as critical provisions for battered
 women. 129 Yet, Latinas have not received sufficient
 resources and services to address their multiple needs.
 Not only are resources scarce and in great demand, but the
 experiences will acknowledge the need to work in unison,
 but only from a strong base. Latino community-based
 organizations must be strengthened and provided with
 the financial and political flexibility to develop and
 establish domestic violence shelters and services. The
 Latino community must prioritize domestic violence
 initiatives. The lives of women and the well-being of an
 entire community depend on it. Similar documents 2026 ©
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greater extent than do other battered women (Gondolf et al., 1988; O'Keefe, 1994; West et al., 1999).

These **Exclude this Text** are exacerbated for undocumented battered Latina women. There is compelling evidence that America's new undocumented migrants are increasingly likely to be women and children. Many researchers have also indicated that more women will be migrating to the United States without their spouses because women are more likely to find jobs in the "hidden" service economy. However, while more immigrant women are coming to the United States seeking a better quality of life for themselves and their families, the barriers they face are tremendous. Fearing deportation and/or the loss of her children, a Latina immigrant battered woman may be intimidated by her partner's threat to report her to the U.S. Immigration and Naturalization Service. She may not realize that domestic violence is against the law, that she has legal options to stop the battering, and that agencies and community resources are available to support her.

There may also be inhibitions based on cultural issues and ambiguities about domestic violence. Different countries and cultures may have their own values and attitudes toward a "woman's place," family, marriage, sex roles, and divorce. Cultural factors such as machismo (male dominance), **exclusion of female behavior**, and traditional family structures with

assistance available from enforcement agencies. A battered Latina woman may be wary of the police, who may have acted **in a violent, repressive manner toward the community at large**, and also must decide whether to seek help from an outsider who does not share her language or any of her cultural values. She is therefore often left to fend for herself at a time of extreme danger and urgency.

Human service providers thus should incorporate cultural factors into their care and intervention and their legislative policy. Law enforcement officials' education strategies must be coordinated with community-based organizations and Latino advocates. Otherwise, the education programs will reflect ingrained stereotypes and merely intensify the problems that the education efforts seek to remedy.

again, it's also under Gloria's recommendations:

acted illegally, are as culpable as the batterer, or cannot be believed.

RECOMMENDATIONS

New methods and strategies to respond **to cultural and racial differences must be central in dealing with the domestic violence movement**. The issues, problems, and experiences of battered Latinas have not been taken into consideration in the human services and social work community or by direct social service providers in state government. The governmental infrastructure charged with enforcing the laws that protect women has failed to adopt legal procedures that are effective in addressing cultural and behavioral

agencies to escape from violent homes. **There is compelling evidence that America's new undocumented migrants are increasingly likely to be women and children**. Many researchers have also indicated that more women **will be migrating to the United States with their spouses because they are able to find jobs in the 'hidden service economy**. However, while more immigrant women are coming to the United States seeking a better quality of life for themselves and their families, the barriers they face are tremendous. Fearing deportation and/or the loss of her children, an immigrant battered woman may be intimidated by her partner's threat to report her to the U.S. immigration and Naturalization Service if she leaves him or calls the police. She **may not realize that domestic violence is against the law, that she has legal options to stop the battering and that there are agencies and community resources available to support her**." Another significant difference

strategy in these communities. (pp.246-247.) It is understandable therefore that Latinas would be suspicious of police who have routinely acted violently and **in a repressive manner toward the Hispanic community at large**. "In addition a Latina must decide whether to invoke assistance from an outsider who may not look like her, sound like her, speak her language, or share **any of her cultural values**...In situations where Latinas must rely on law enforcement officials for assistance, they usually meet officers who are not bilingual or bicultural... and the women therefore are left to care for themselves, to seek translation **at a time of extreme danger and urgency**." (p. 246.) Rivera also suggests that law enforcement officials must be educated

Hispanic men and women expect Latinos to react physically in situations of domestic conflict. (p. 247.) With all of these barriers: language, fear of police, racism, culture, it is no wonder that Latina battered women tend to endure abuse for longer periods of time before ever seeking help, if they even seek help. Suggested Solutions: These articles all state that consideration of and responsiveness **to cultural and racial differences must be central** to any strategies **in the domestic violence movement**. There must be education within the Hispanic community, specifically addressing domestic violence and its illegality, outreach to Hispanic women and domestic violence services tailored to their specific needs. Trust and good faith must be fostered

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